

Yuepeng Yang

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APPOINTMENTS

The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania

July 2026 – Present

Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Statistics and Data Science

Advised by Prof. Yuxin Chen and Prof. Yuejie Chi

Yale University

2025 – 2026

Postdoctoral Associate, Department of Statistics and Data Science

Advised by Prof. Yuxin Chen and Prof. Yuejie Chi

EDUCATION

University of Chicago

2020 – 2025

Ph.D. in Statistics

Advised by Prof. Cong Ma

Dissertation: “Statistical Estimation with Heterogeneous Data Structures.”

Carnegie Mellon University

2016 – 2020

B.S. and M.S. in Mathematical Sciences

Master’s thesis advised by Prof. Dejan Slepčev

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Statistical learning theory; structured matrix estimation and data integration; ranking and preference learning; reinforcement learning.

RESEARCH PAPERS

1. Xianwen Song, **Yuepeng Yang**, and Cong Ma. “Bias-corrected subspace intersection: minimax-optimal shared subspace estimation in multi-view data.” *arXiv preprint*, 2026.
2. **Yuepeng Yang**, Yuxin Chen, and Yuejie Chi. “Robust average-reward Markov decision processes: minimax-optimal learning via plug-in reductions.” *arXiv preprint*, 2026.
3. **Yuepeng Yang** and Cong Ma. “Sample efficient inductive matrix completion with noise and inexact side information.” *arXiv preprint*, 2026. Submitted to *Journal of the American Statistical Association*.
4. **Yuepeng Yang** and Cong Ma. “Random pairing MLE for estimation of item parameters in Rasch model.” *Journal of the American Statistical Association*, published online, 2026.
5. **Yuepeng Yang** and Cong Ma. “Estimating shared subspace with AJIVE: the power and limitation of multiple data matrices.” *arXiv preprint*, 2025. Minor revision at *Journal of Machine Learning Research*.
6. **Yuepeng Yang**, Antares Chen, Lorenzo Orecchia, and Cong Ma. “Top- K ranking with a monotone adversary.” *Conference on Learning Theory*, 2024.

RESEARCH PAPERS (CONTINUED)

7. **Yuepeng Yang** and Cong Ma. “ $O(T^{-1})$ Convergence of optimistic-follow-the-regularized-leader in two-player zero-sum Markov games.” *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2023.
8. **Yuepeng Yang** and Cong Ma. “Optimal tuning-free convex relaxation for noisy matrix completion.” *IEEE Transactions on Information Theory*, 2023.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

- “Sample Complexity of Distributionally Robust Average Reward MDP.” Invited presentation, Theoretical Foundations of Reinforcement Learning session, INFORMS Optimization Society Conference, Atlanta, March 2026.
- “Discussion of ‘Matrix Completion When Missing Is Not at Random and Its Applications in Causal Panel Data Models’.” Invited discussant, JASA Theory and Methods Discussion Paper, Joint Statistical Meetings, Nashville, August 2025.
- “Ranking from sparse comparison data with non-uniformity.” The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen, January 2025.
- “Top- K ranking with a monotone adversary.” Conference on Learning Theory, Edmonton, July 2024.
- “ $O(T^{-1})$ Convergence of optimistic-follow-the-regularized-leader in two-player zero-sum Markov games.” SIAM Conference on Optimization, Seattle, May 2023.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, University of Chicago

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| • STAT 38300 Measure-Theoretic Probability III | Spring 2023, 2024, 2025 |
| • STAT 27815 Practical R Programming | Autumn 2024 |
| • STAT 31015 Convex Optimization | Winter 2024 |
| • STAT 23400 Statistical Models and Methods | Fall, Winter, Spring 2021; Spring 2022 |
| • STAT 37710 Machine Learning | Fall 2022 |

Teaching Assistant, Carnegie Mellon University

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| • 21-268 Multidimensional Calculus | Spring 2020 |
| • 21-269 Vector Analysis | Spring 2019 |

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Journal reviewer for *Annals of Statistics*, *Journal of the American Statistical Association*, *Biometrika*, and *IEEE Transactions on Information Theory*.